

are open to the suspicion of having been coloured by their transmission through Jewish hands. Notice in 6, 9. 10. 12 the technical expressions of the Jewish law; in *v.* 10 "savour of satisfaction; in *v.* 12^a a phrase characteristic of Dt. (p. 94, No. 35). The dialect in which it is written (including the edicts) is the Western, or *Palestinian*, Aramaic (p. 471).

6, 19-22 (where the Hebrew recommences) the compiler (as is plain from the phraseology) speaks again in his own person.¹

The second section of the book, c. 7-10, dealing with Ezra's own age, there is no reason to doubt, is throughout either written by Ezra or based upon materials left by him. 7, 27-9, 15—with the exception, as it seems, of occasional glosses or slight additions made by the compiler—is thus an extract from Ezra's own memoirs. But 7, 1-10 is certainly not Ezra's work, though doubtless composed on the basis of Ezra's materials; it is manifestly a summary account of Ezra, prefixed by the compiler as an introduction to the excerpt from Ezra's memoirs which follows.

In 7, 1-10 notice (*a*) the omission of Ezra's immediate ancestors (for Seraiah was contemporary with Zedekiah, 2 Ki. 25, 18. 21, 130 years previously to Ezra's time); (*b*) the fact that *vv.* 7-9 anticipate c. 8; (*c*) the expressions of the compiler in *v.* 10 (p. 503, Nos. 6, 7; esp. 2 Ch. 12, 14. 19, 3. 30, 19). The phrase in *vv.* 6 *end.* 9 *end.* will be naturally taken from Ezra's memoirs (see 7, 28). In 7, 27-9, 15, the clause in 8, 20 "whom," &c., for instance, reads like an explanatory gloss; notice also *ו*, never besides in *Ezr.* *Neh.*, and only twice in *Ch.*, I 5, 20. 27, 27; the last clause of the verse includes a phrase of the compiler's (p. 503, No. 12). And 8, 35 f. (unlike the context) is written without reference to Ezra himself; it is not improbable therefore that it may have been condensed by the compiler from Ezra's own more detailed and personal description. The decree of Artaxerxes, 7, 12-26, as is evident from the terms of 7, 27, must also have stood in Ezra's memoirs, though it may have been cast into its present form by one familiar with the terminology of the Jewish sacred books (see *vv.* 13^b [p. 504, No. 23]. 15. 16. 17. 24. 26; comp. Ewald, i. 191). The dialect, as before, is the Palestinian Aramaic. In *substance*, it is undoubtedly genuine (Stade, ii. 153).

C. 10, though the immediate sequel of c. 9, is distinguished from it by the use of the third person, and also by being in parts considerably less circumstantial (see especially the brief and incomplete notices in *vv.* 15. 16 f.): at the same time, in other

¹ Perhaps, indeed (Schrad. p. 477; Ryssel, pp. xiv, xix; Kuen. § 34. 9), *vv.* 16-18 are also due to the compiler, who, designing them as the conclusion of the *Aramaic* narrative of the building of the Temple, may have written them in the same language.